

Case Study: Window Production Throughput Improvement

Challenge

Chronic backlogs of windows were piling up in the backorder area because key parts were missing. Assembly floors often started but couldn't be completed, leading to delays, excess WIP, and client dissatisfaction.

Action

- Performed **Root Cause Analysis** and **time studies** across all sub-departments.
- Found some sub-departments had cycle times 2–3x longer than others, creating bottlenecks.
- Introduced a new rule: **two auditors per shift** verify all parts are ready before assembly begins.
- Enforced a **24-hour rule**: no new project could start until older backorders were cleared.
- Engaged suppliers to stop partial deliveries and ensure full project kits arrived.

Result

- **Eliminated backlogs**, ensuring continuous production flow.
- Increased monthly window production from **10,000** → **11,000 units** (+10%).
- Clients received projects on time, leading to **higher satisfaction and confidence**.
- Established a sustainable readiness standard that stabilized operations.